

Olympiad Test Paper — Sanskrit (Class 7) — Paper 5

Chapter 8: हितं मनोहारि च दुर्लभं वचः (Hitam Manohari cha Durlabham Vachah)

Paper 5 — (progressively harder)

Subject	Sanskrit (NCERT Class 7, Deepakam)
Chapter	8 — हितं मनोहारि च दुर्लभं वचः (Hitam Manohari cha Durlabham Vachah)
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. Reading च as the disjunctive 'or' to soften the both-AND bar; collapsing दुर्लभम् (rare-but-attainable) into अशक्यम् (impossible); swapping the distributive adverbs (विद्या→क्षणशः, अर्थः→क्षणशः) or treating the indeclinable -शस् form as a declining case; mis-resolving the sandhi seams (मनः+हारि as 'mind-harm', सु+उक्ति as anything but ऊ-coalescence); mistaking the neuter-singular qualifiers for nouns in apposition; and crediting the eloquent विकृत्यन over the silent क्रियावान्. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

1. Model speech as a point in a 2x2 grid (useful: yes/no along one axis, pleasing: yes/no along the other). The verse calls दुर्लभम् exactly the intersection cell. If, in a class of 40 utterances, 20 are useful and 24 are pleasing, what is the SMALLEST possible number that could satisfy the verse's both-AND standard?

- (A) 4 — when overlap is minimised, useful-and-pleasing = $20 + 24 - 40 = 4$
- (B) 20 — every useful utterance is automatically also pleasing
- (C) 24 — the pleasing ones already include all the useful ones
- (D) 0 — useful and pleasing can never coincide, since the verse calls the overlap rare

2. A pupil reasons: 'Since हितम् and मनोहारि are listed together and joined by च, removing either word leaves the verse meaning the same thing.' The deepest fault in this is that:

- (A) each adjective contributes an independent, non-redundant property, so dropping one collapses the rare 'intersection' into a far commoner single-property class
- (B) the words truly are interchangeable, so the pupil is correct and either may be dropped freely

- (C) only दुर्लभम् may be dropped without changing the meaning, never हितम् or मनोहारि
(D) च forbids removing any word for purely grammatical reasons, with no effect on the meaning

3. Which utterance most precisely embodies the verse's hardest cell — failing NEITHER half — while every other choice fails a different single half?

- (A) A salesman cheerfully promising a cure he knows will not work
(B) A doctor telling a frightened patient the true diagnosis gently, with a clear, hopeful plan
(C) A coach barking a correct but contemptuous insult that does fix the player's stance
(D) A friend who, fearing to upset you, says nothing about the danger ahead

4. The verse's logic is 'requiring two demanding independent traits at once makes the result rare.' A student infers: 'Therefore demanding THREE such traits would make it common again.' Correct him.

- (A) He is right: each new trait gives speech one more way to qualify, so three traits make it common
(B) Three traits leave rarity exactly unchanged, since दुर्लभम् already names the floor of rarity
(C) Adding a further independent demand shrinks the qualifying set still more, so a three-trait ideal is rarer, not commoner, than the two-trait one
(D) Adding a third trait makes the ideal अशक्यम् — strictly impossible rather than merely rare

5. A flatterer's compliment and a blunt critic's rebuke each fail the verse oppositely. If you HAD to combine the two people's strengths into one speaker, that speaker would supply:

- (A) the critic's truthful benefit (हितम्) wrapped in the flatterer's agreeableness (मनोहारि) — exactly the दुर्लभम् ideal
(B) the flatterer's pleasantness alone, since pleasing speech is what the verse prizes above all
(C) the critic's harsh honesty alone, since usefulness is the only half that truly matters
(D) neither strength, since combining two speakers produces speech that is both useless and harsh

6. Why does the verse call ideal speech 'rare' rather than simply praising 'useful speech' and separately praising 'pleasing speech'?

- (A) Because useful speech by itself is already impossibly rare, so the combination is barely worth naming
(B) Because pleasing speech is so harmful that it must be diluted with usefulness to be acceptable

(C) Because Sanskrit grammar forbids praising two qualities separately within a single verse line

(D) Pinning rarity on the COMBINATION says the difficulty lies precisely in fusing benefit with pleasantness, not in either quality alone — each is common enough by itself

7. On a frequency line running सुलभम् — दुर्लभम् — अशक्यम्, a debater claims दुर्लभम् sits 'closer to अशक्यम् than to सुलभम्, so practically impossible.' The precise correction is that दुर्लभम्:

(A) names a different KIND of claim from अशक्यम् (difficulty vs negation of possibility), so no nearness-on-the-line makes it 'practically impossible'

(B) does sit nearer अशक्यम्, so the debater is essentially right that it is near-impossible

(C) sits exactly at the midpoint, making it equally easy and impossible at once

(D) is itself the अशक्यम् end of the line, the two words marking the same point

8. दुर्लभम् = दुर् + लभ् ('obtain'), सुलभम् = सु + लभ्. Holding the शेष root fixed and swapping ONLY the prefix, what does this minimal pair prove about the prefixes themselves?

(A) दुर्- and सु- are mere decoration; the meaning rests entirely in -लभ्, so both words mean the same

(B) दुर्- means 'easy' and सु- means 'hard', so the two words' meanings are the reverse of the usual gloss

(C) दुर्- and सु- are an opposed pair meaning 'hard/ill' versus 'easy/well', and they alone flip a word from 'hard to get' to 'easy to get'

(D) both prefixes intensify -लभ् in the same direction, making both words mean 'very obtainable'

9. A banner reads 'सत्यं दुर्लभम् — सततं यतस्व' ('truth is rare — keep striving'). If अशक्यम् were substituted for दुर्लभम्, why would the banner become self-contradictory?

(A) अशक्यम् means 'common', so striving would be unnecessary rather than contradictory

(B) अशक्यम् would assert truth is unattainable, which makes the call to keep striving toward it pointless; दुर्लभम् keeps it reachable and so rewards striving

(C) the two words are synonyms, so no contradiction could arise from the swap

(D) अशक्यम् would make the banner stronger, since impossible goals best motivate effort

10. Place these on the frequency line, hardest-to-find LAST: (i) speech that is useful (हितम्); (ii) speech that is both useful and pleasing; (iii) speech that is impossible to utter at all.

The verse's word for (ii) versus (iii) is:

(A) (ii) is दुर्लभम् (rare yet reachable) and (iii) is अशक्यम् (impossible) — (ii) is hard but not at the impossible extreme

(B) both (ii) and (iii) are दुर्लभम्, since rare and impossible mean the same in the verse

(C) (ii) is अशक्यम् and (iii) is दुर्लभम्, the harder being the merely rare one

(D) (ii) is सुलभम् (easy) because combining two common qualities is itself common

11. By analogy with दुर्लभम् ('hard to obtain') and दुर्गमम् ('hard to traverse'), the form दुर्बोधम् would most exactly mean:

- (A) hard to understand — दुर्- adds difficulty to बोध ('understanding')
- (B) impossible to understand — दुर्- flatly negates the possibility of बोध
- (C) easy to understand — दुर्- here commends and eases the act of बोध
- (D) twice understood — दुर्- doubles the act of बोध

12. A student claims दुर्लभम् in the verse means 'rarely valuable.' Diagnose the precise error.

- (A) दुर्लभम् describes how hard the speech is to FIND (rarity of occurrence), not how often it is valuable — value is carried by हितम्/मनोहारि
- (B) There is no error; दुर्लभम् does mean 'rarely valuable'
- (C) The error is that दुर्लभम् means 'always valuable', the opposite of the student's claim
- (D) The error is that दुर्लभम् is an adverb modifying how the speech is spoken, not its frequency

13. वचः belongs to the neuter sibilant (-स्) stem class, like मनः, तेजः, यशः. Reasoning from the stem class alone, the three qualifiers हितम्, मनोहारि, दुर्लभम् must therefore stand in:

- (A) the masculine singular, since adjectives in Sanskrit default to masculine regardless of the noun
- (B) the neuter plural, because three separate qualities require a plural form
- (C) no fixed gender at all, since adjectives are indeclinable like adverbs
- (D) the neuter singular, to agree with the neuter-singular noun वचः they describe

14. If वचः were replaced by the masculine noun उपदेशः ('counsel'), the qualifier 'beneficial' would correctly appear as:

- (A) हितम् — the neuter form is fixed and never changes with the noun
- (B) हिता — the feminine, since counsel about welfare is conceptually feminine
- (C) हितः — the masculine singular, now matching the masculine noun
- (D) हितानि — the neuter plural, because counsel implies many words

15. The visarga in वचः is not a random sign but the surface form of its stem-final consonant. That consonant is:

- (A) -र् (the prefix consonant), as in दुर्- before लम्
- (B) -न् (a nasal), as in masculine -न् stems like राजन्
- (C) -स् (sibilant), exactly as in मनस् → मनः
- (D) -त् (a dental stop), surfacing as visarga before a pause

16. A student parses the line as 'four nouns in apposition: a benefit, a heart-stealer, a rarity, and a speech.' The single grammatical fact that refutes this is:

- (A) all four words are verbs, so none can be a noun in apposition
- (B) the words are in four different cases, which apposition forbids

- (C) वचः is itself an adjective, so the other three must be the nouns
 (D) three of the words are adjectives sharing वचः's neuter-singular form because they qualify it — only वचः is the substantive

17. Suppose a verse read 'मधुरं हितं च वचः सुलभम्' ('sweet and useful speech is easy to find'). Compared with the original, which TWO independent shifts has it made?

- (A) It changes च to वा and keeps दुर्लभम्, loosening only the conjunction
 (B) It keeps the both-AND conjunction but reverses the rarity, calling such speech सुलभम् (easy) instead of दुर्लभम् (rare) — and substitutes a synonym मधुरम् for मनोहारि
 (C) It changes nothing of substance, since मधुरम्/मनोहारि and सुलभम्/दुर्लभम् are pairwise synonyms
 (D) It makes the standard harder on both counts, demanding more qualities and greater rarity

18. The -स् stem behaviour of वचः/मनस् most directly explains the spelling of which OTHER word in the lesson?

- (A) क्रियावान् — its -वान् is a neuter -स् stem like वचः
 (B) मनोहारि — its first member मनः (from मनस्) shows the same visarga-to-'o' shift before a voiced sound
 (C) दुर्लभम् — its दुर्- prefix is a neuter -स् stem
 (D) क्षणशः — its -शः ending is the same neuter -स् stem

19. मनोहारि resolves as मनः + हारि. The change मनः → मनो at the seam is an instance of which sandhi rule, and what triggers it?

- (A) Vowel sandhi: two like vowels 'a + a' coalesce into long 'ā', so मन + अहारि gives मनाहारि
 (B) Consonant doubling: ह doubles after the visarga, giving मनःहहारि
 (C) No sandhi at all: मनः is simply written मनो by spelling convention
 (D) Visarga sandhi: a visarga preceded by 'a' turns to 'o' before a voiced consonant — here the voiced ह of हारि

20. If the second member of the compound had instead begun with a VOICELESS consonant — say मनः + करम् — what would visarga sandhi most plausibly yield, by contrast with मनोहारि?

- (A) मनोकरम् — the visarga becomes 'o' before any following consonant, voiced or voiceless
 (B) मनाकरम् — the preceding 'a' lengthens to 'ā' before the voiceless क्
 (C) मनस्करम् / मनःकरम् — the visarga stays a sibilant-type sound before the voiceless क्, it does NOT become 'o'
 (D) मन्करम् — the visarga simply drops with no other change

21. सूक्तिः = सु + उक्तिः. The seam सु + उ produces सू by which mechanism, and what would the WRONG mechanism (treating it as unlike vowels) have produced?

- (A) Unlike vowels a + i yield 'e', giving सेक्तिः; the like-vowel rule does not apply
 (B) उ + उ yield the diphthong औ, giving सौक्तिः

- (C) the vowels stay separate with a hiatus, giving सु-उक्तिः unchanged
(D) Like vowels उ + उ coalesce into long ऊ, giving सू-; treating them as unlike would wrongly yield the semivowel व् (स्व-) or a diphthong

22. The enclitic च in मनोहारि च is written separately, even though मनोहारि ends in a vowel. The reason no merger occurs is that:

- (A) च begins with the consonant च्, so there is no vowel-meets-vowel junction to trigger a vowel-sandhi merger
(B) मनोहारि actually ends in a consonant, which forbids sandhi with च
(C) च is a verb, and verbs never join to neighbouring words
(D) च is emphatic, and emphatic particles always block all sandhi

23. An enclitic च placed AFTER a word conventionally links that word to the one before it. In हितं मनोहारि च, this means च groups:

- (A) मनोहारि (which it follows) with हितम् (which precedes) — 'useful and pleasing' together
(B) वचः with दुर्लभम्, the two words at the line's end
(C) only the word after च, leaving हितम् ungrouped
(D) all four words equally, since च is a universal connective

24. सुभाषितम् is built on the same प्रकार as सूक्तिः. Resolving its sandhi seam सु + भाषितम्, why is there NO vowel-coalescence here even though सूक्तिः showed one?

- (A) सुभाषितम् does undergo coalescence, giving सूभाषितम् with a long ऊ
(B) सु here means 'six', not 'well', so the sandhi rule does not apply
(C) भाषितम् begins with a vowel, so the two vowels merge into a diphthong
(D) भाषितम् begins with the consonant भ्, so सु meets a consonant — no vowel-meets-vowel junction, unlike सु + उ in सूक्तिः

25. क्षणशः and कणशः both end in -शः. A student declines कणशः into an instrumental कणशेन. The error is that:

- (A) the -शस् form is an indeclinable adverb ('grain by grain'), so it takes no case endings and cannot be made instrumental
(B) the correct instrumental is कणशसा, not कणशेन — the ending is merely wrong
(C) कणशः is a feminine noun, so its instrumental is कणश्या
(D) the word is a verb and so should be conjugated, not declined, as कणशति

26. The verse pairs विद्या with क्षणशः and अर्थः with कणशः. The DEEPEST reason this pairing resists swapping is that:

- (A) knowledge is literally made of moments and wealth literally made of grains, so the words name the nouns' substance
(B) the pairing is arbitrary and the two adverbs may be swapped with no loss of meaning

(C) both grow identically, so क्षणशः and कणशः mean exactly the same thing
(D) knowledge accrues through units of TIME spent (moments of study), whereas wealth accrues through small physical UNITS (grains/coins) saved — so each adverb fits its own noun's mode of growth

27. Extending the pattern, a new line 'कीर्तिः कर्मशः वर्धते' ('fame grows deed by deed') forms कर्मशः exactly as क्षणशः/कणशः are formed. That formation is:

- (A) verb-root कृ + suffix → a finite verb meaning 'it acts'
- (B) noun कर्म + a dative ending → 'for the sake of the deed'
- (C) adjective कर्मन् + ending → a word agreeing with कीर्तिः in gender
- (D) noun (कर्म, 'deed') + the distributive suffix -शस् → an indeclinable adverb 'deed by deed'

28. A boy memorises five new words each morning for two years. Which verse-adverb names how his vocabulary grew, and what disqualifies the other adverb?

- (A) कणशः — because five words a day are counted out like physical grains
- (B) neither — adverbs cannot describe the growth of vocabulary at all
- (C) क्षणशः — the words were learnt through repeated small units of TIME (daily moments of study), whereas कणशः belongs to physical-particle saving like coins
- (D) both equally — क्षणशः and कणशः describe any gradual growth interchangeably

29. क्षणशः and कणशः differ by only one syllable yet describe different nouns. The single sound-difference that carries the whole meaning-difference is:

- (A) the suffix — one is -शस् and the other -शम्, giving them different grammatical roles
- (B) the gender — क्षणशः is masculine and कणशः feminine, which redirects each to its noun
- (C) nothing meaningful — the words are spelling variants of a single adverb
- (D) the base noun — क्षण ('moment', a unit of time) versus कण ('particle/grain', a physical unit); the shared -शस् suffix is identical

30. Why is it apt that the verse uses the SAME suffix -शस् for both knowledge and wealth, despite their different bases?

- (A) Because knowledge and wealth are the same thing, so naturally they share every affix
- (B) Because -शस् is the only adverb-suffix in Sanskrit, so the poet had no alternative
- (C) Both grow by patient, repeated increments, and -शस् is exactly the 'unit by unit' suffix, so a shared suffix marks their shared mode of gradual accumulation
- (D) Because the suffix forces both nouns into the same gender for rhyme

31. क्रियावान् = क्रिया + -वत्/-वान्, and क्रिया traces to the root कृ ('to do/make'). Chaining BOTH facts, the word most fundamentally praises:

- (A) one who possesses fine words about action — i.e. an eloquent describer of deeds
- (B) one who possesses real action — i.e. who actually does and performs deeds

(C) one who lacks action — i.e. who stays idle, since -वान् here means 'without'

(D) one who opposes action — i.e. who prevents others from acting

32. Two pupils: A finishes a quiet, thorough model and submits it; B, before starting, loudly forecasts the prize his model will win. The verse-cluster's correct labels and the reasoning are:

(A) B is the क्रियावान् because confident announcement is itself a kind of action

(B) A is the praiseworthy क्रियावान् (his completed deed speaks), B is the criticised विकृत्यन् (his talk outruns his undone work)

(C) both are विकृत्यन् because each produced or promised a model

(D) both are क्रियावान् because each spoke aloud about the work

33. The क्रियावान्-over-विकृत्यन् preference is a special case of which broader principle, and how does it harmonise with the speech-verse rather than contradicting it?

(A) It endorses कथन over कर्म; this contradicts the speech-verse, which prizes only talk

(B) It endorses कर्म (deeds) over mere कथन (talk); this agrees with the speech-verse, which also subordinates empty display to genuine worth — speech must truly help and please, not merely sound nice

(C) It endorses अर्थ over विद्या; this is unrelated to the speech-verse's concerns

(D) It endorses total silence over both speech and action; this overrides the speech-verse entirely

34. A विकृत्यन् insists 'my eloquent promises ARE my contribution.' By the chapter's deepest logic, the flaw mirrors which OTHER chapter trap?

(A) It mirrors mistaking मनोहारि-alone (pleasing words) for the full ideal — pleasant or impressive speech without the backing of real benefit/deed fails the both-AND standard

(B) It mirrors mistaking क्षणशः for कणशः — swapping knowledge's adverb for wealth's

(C) It mirrors mistaking सूक्तिः for सूक्ष्म — a good saying for a subtle thing

(D) It mirrors mistaking दुर्लभम् for सुलभम् — calling the rare thing easy

35. Which proverb most exactly distils the क्रियावान्/विकृत्यन् teaching, and why do the others fail it?

(A) 'Promise grandly first; the doing can wait or never come' — talk before deeds

(B) 'A polished boast is worth more than a plain deed' — talk above deeds

(C) 'Do nothing, say nothing, and let fortune decide' — neither talk nor deeds

(D) 'Let your deeds speak so loudly that your boasts become needless' — deeds over talk

36. सूक्तिः and सूक्ष्म both open with the sound सू, a classic trap. The structurally RELIABLE way to keep them apart is:

(A) both embed उक्ति, so both ultimately relate to speech

(B) सूक्तिः contains उक्ति ('saying'), marking it a GOOD SAYING; सूक्ष्म has no उक्ति and means SUBTLE/fine

(C) सूक्ष्म embeds उक्ति, so it denotes a refined or subtle saying

(D) the shared सू- guarantees they are exact synonyms

37. A teacher writes a सूक्ति: on the board and a colleague guesses it must be 'a subtle riddle.' The colleague has fallen into which exact confusion, and what should actually appear?

(A) He confused सूक्ति: with सूक्ष्म; what should appear is a brief, well-phrased wise saying (a सुभाषितम्)

(B) He confused सूक्ति: with विकृत्यन; what should appear is a boast about the teacher

(C) He confused सूक्ति: with भाण्डागारः; what should appear is an inventory of stored treasures

(D) He confused सूक्ति: with कुतूहलम्; what should appear is a list of curious questions

38. कुतूहलम् is glossed as कौतुकम् and kin to जिज्ञासा (Chapter 1, a desiderative of ज्ञा 'to know'). The single thread the chapter prizes in all three is:

(A) the eagerness to BOAST — a talker's pride in display

(B) the eagerness to REST — an idle person's wish to avoid effort

(C) the eagerness to KNOW — a learner's curiosity that drives the patient gathering of knowledge

(D) the eagerness for WEALTH — a merchant's drive to accumulate riches

39. Why is जिज्ञासा an especially fitting cousin of कुतूहलम् in a chapter that also teaches क्षणशः-gathering of knowledge?

(A) जिज्ञासा means 'the wish for wealth', which drives the क्षणशः saving of अर्थः

(B) जिज्ञासा means 'the wish to boast', which the chapter praises in the विकृत्यन

(C) जिज्ञासा is literally 'the wish to know', and that wish is what sustains the moment-by-moment study by which knowledge (विद्या) is accumulated

(D) जिज्ञासा means 'the wish to rest', explaining why knowledge comes without effort

40. भाण्डागारः ('treasure-trove/storehouse') is the chapter's metaphor for knowledge. Why does it pair so naturally with knowledge gathered क्षणशः rather than with a sudden windfall?

(A) A storehouse fills in a single instant, matching a flash of sudden insight

(B) A storehouse holds only coins and never knowledge, making the metaphor ironic

(C) A storehouse is always empty, like the unfulfilled claims of a boaster

(D) A storehouse fills item by item over time, exactly mirroring how knowledge accumulates moment by moment

41. शीलम् recurs across chapters as the deepest value. A person who speaks beautifully (मनोहारि), counsels usefully (हितम्), and is wealthy, yet cheats others, by the chapter's standard still lacks:

(A) शीलम् (good character), which outweighs eloquence and wealth alike

(B) वचः (the power of speech), which the cheat plainly already possesses

- (C) कुतूहलम् (curiosity), which has no bearing on his dishonesty
- (D) भाण्डागारः (a treasure-store), which his wealth already supplies

42. That शीलम् reappears after earlier chapters, beside the praise of true speech and real deeds, reveals the Deepakam's unifying ideal of:

- (A) an outwardly impressive person, regardless of inner conduct
- (B) a wealthy person, measured only by riches accumulated कणशः
- (C) an inwardly good person whose conduct, speech and action all flow from good character
- (D) a clever talker, measured only by eloquence and pleasing speech

43. A manager must tell an underperforming employee a hard truth. Which delivery realises हितं मनोहारि च, and why does each rejected one fail a SPECIFIC half?

- (A) Wrap it in vague praise that hides the actual problem — this is pleasing but lacks हितम्
- (B) Deliver a blunt, humiliating dressing-down that does fix the issue — this is useful but lacks मनोहारि
- (C) Say nothing and hope for improvement — this supplies neither half
- (D) State the real problem clearly while framing it with respect and a path forward — useful (हितम्) and pleasing (मनोहारि) together

44. Read the line as a one-way conditional: 'IF speech is both useful and pleasing, THEN it is rare.' Observing that some speech IS rare lets you conclude about its being both useful and pleasing:

- (A) that it must be both useful and pleasing, since the two are equivalent
- (B) that it is neither useful nor pleasing, since rare things lack qualities
- (C) nothing certain — rarity is the consequence, not the cause, and a conditional cannot be run backwards
- (D) that it is actually common, contradicting the observation

45. A student calls a true but deliberately wounding rebuke 'the verse's ideal, because the truth always pleases.' The precise correction is:

- (A) He is right: any true statement is automatically both useful and pleasing
- (B) It is मनोहारि but not हितम्, so it fails the usefulness half
- (C) It is हितम् but not मनोहारि — truth does not automatically please — so it meets only one half; the ideal requires the pleasing quality too
- (D) It is neither हितम् nor मनोहारि, so it lies wholly outside the verse

46. Apply the verse to advertising: a slogan is catchy and beloved (highly मनोहारि) but misleads buyers about the product. By the verse's standard it fails because:

- (A) lacking truthful benefit it is not हितम्, and the verse demands BOTH, so pleasantness alone cannot satisfy it
- (B) being मनोहारि is itself condemned by the verse, so any pleasing slogan fails

(C) it cannot fail, since a pleasing slogan automatically meets the whole verse

(D) it fails only on a grammatical point, not on the both-AND meaning

47. Generalising the verse's logic beyond speech: in any domain, a candidate that must satisfy TWO demanding, independent criteria will, compared with one needing only a single criterion, be:

(A) more common — two criteria give the candidate two separate ways to qualify

(B) exactly as common — adding a second criterion changes nothing

(C) rarer — the qualifying group is the smaller intersection of the two single-criterion groups

(D) impossible — no candidate can ever meet two criteria simultaneously

48. Synthesise the speech-cluster (हितम्/मनोहारि/दुर्लभम्/वचः) with the effort-cluster (क्षणशः/कणशः/क्रियावान्/विकृत्यन). The single value threading BOTH clusters is:

(A) eloquence and boasting are the highest goods celebrated across both clusters

(B) genuine, hard-won substance triumphs over easy or empty show — worthy speech over hollow words, and real deeds patiently earned over boasting

(C) instant results gained without any effort are praised throughout both clusters

(D) the two clusters share no value and pull in opposite directions

49. Reading the speech-verse and the क्षणशः-कणशः verse together yields one shared moral about worthwhile things. It is best stated as:

(A) they are easy and instantly obtained, so no effort is needed

(B) they are truly impossible and so not worth pursuing

(C) they are rare/hard yet attainable through patient, sustained, incremental effort

(D) they are gained mainly by loud and frequent boasting

50. Compress the chapter's whole ethic into one rule of conduct. The most faithful is:

(A) Speak loudly, get rich fast, boast of your deeds, and pay no heed to character

(B) Speak words both useful and pleasing, gather knowledge and wealth patiently bit by bit, act rather than boast, and let good character guide all

(C) Stay silent, shun effort, and trust to luck for everything

(D) Prize pleasing speech alone and disregard usefulness and conduct

51. Which SINGLE set of four word-meanings is entirely correct?

(A) दुर्लभम् = impossible; मनोहारि = useful; क्रियावान् = boaster; सूक्तिः = subtle

(B) दुर्लभम् = common; मनोहारि = pleasing; क्रियावान् = doer; सूक्तिः = subtle

(C) दुर्लभम् = rare; मनोहारि = harsh; क्रियावान् = boaster; सूक्तिः = good saying

(D) दुर्लभम् = rare; मनोहारि = pleasing; क्रियावान् = doer; सूक्तिः = good saying

52. A composite mis-reading runs: 'च = or; दुर्लभम् = impossible; मनोहारि = mind-harming; क्षणशः = all at once.' How many of these four claims are wrong?

- (A) Exactly two are wrong (B) Only the च claim is wrong
(C) None is wrong; all four are correct (D) All four are wrong

53. Suppose the verse were extended: 'सत्यं प्रियं हितं च दुर्लभं वचः.' Holding the original grammar fixed, सत्यम्, प्रियम् and हितम् would function as:

- (A) three separate nouns naming separate things, with च meaning 'or' between them
(B) three more neuter-singular adjectives, joined by च, all qualifying the same neuter noun वचः
(C) three adverbs modifying दुर्लभम् rather than वचः
(D) a subject (सत्यम्), an object (प्रियम्) and a verb (हितम्)

54. A reviewer argues: 'The verse is mere grammar — it only describes a kind of speech, prescribing nothing.' The strongest reply is:

- (A) The reply fails: a description of speech can carry no ethical weight at all
(B) By calling beneficial-and-pleasing speech rare-but-attainable, the verse implicitly urges us to cultivate it — describing a rare ideal carries a quiet prescription to pursue it
(C) The verse is purely grammatical, since वचः is just a noun being parsed
(D) The verse is really about scarce goods, since दुर्लभम् names market scarcity

55. Across the chapter, सूक्तिः, कुतूहलम्, भाण्डागारः and शीलम् together endorse a life built on:

- (A) boasting, laziness, hoarded wealth, and pride
(B) silence, idleness, luck, and indifference
(C) wise speech, curiosity, treasured knowledge, and good character
(D) harsh speech, greed, secrecy, and impossibility

56. The chapter prizes the क्रियावान् yet ALSO commends sweet, pleasing (मनोहारि) speech. A cynic says these conflict: 'one says act, the other says talk nicely.' Resolve the apparent tension.

- (A) They do conflict, and the chapter ultimately abandons the speech-verse in favour of pure action
(B) They conflict, and the chapter ultimately abandons action in favour of pleasing speech
(C) There is no conflict because the chapter actually treats speaking and doing as identical
(D) There is no conflict — the chapter rejects empty talk (boasting), not all speech; speech that genuinely helps and pleases is itself a worthy act, complementing real deeds

57. A learner displays कुतूहलम् by constantly asking 'why?'. A teacher mislabels her a विकत्थन for 'always speaking up.' The mislabel is wrong because:

- (A) she truly is a विकत्थन, since any frequent speaker is by definition a boaster
(B) asking questions to LEARN is curiosity (कुतूहलम्), whereas विकत्थन is boasting about one's own greatness — speaking to seek knowledge is not boasting

(C) she is neither, since curiosity and boasting both require staying silent

(D) she is a भाण्डागारः, because asking many questions stores up treasure

58. Why does the chapter's choice of दुर्लभम् (over अशक्यम्) for ideal speech harmonise with its क्षणशः/कणशः teaching about knowledge and wealth?

(A) Both say worthwhile goods are hard-but-reachable through patient effort — rare speech can be cultivated just as knowledge and wealth are built up bit by bit

(B) Both say worthwhile goods are impossible, so neither speech nor wealth is worth pursuing

(C) Both say worthwhile goods come instantly, so neither requires patience

(D) They do not harmonise: one teaches rarity, the other teaches abundance

59. Of the verse's four key words, exactly one is the substantive and three qualify it. The fully correct assignment, tested against the neuter-singular agreement, is:

(A) दुर्लभम् is the noun; वचः, हितम् and मनोहारि qualify it

(B) वचः is the qualified noun; हितम्, मनोहारि and दुर्लभम् are its three neuter-singular qualifiers

(C) हितम् is the noun; वचः, मनोहारि and दुर्लभम् qualify it

(D) all four are co-equal nouns, with no qualifier among them

60. Final synthesis: the single best one-sentence restatement of हितं मनोहारि च दुर्लभं वचः, capturing every nuance the chapter stresses, is:

(A) Speech that is either beneficial or pleasing is easy to find everywhere

(B) Speech that is at once beneficial (हितम्) AND pleasing (मनोहारि) is rare (दुर्लभम्) — yet, being merely rare and not impossible, it is well worth striving for

(C) Beneficial speech can never be produced, so one should not try

(D) Pleasing speech is always harmful and should therefore be avoided

Solutions — Sanskrit (Class 7), Chapter 8: हितं मनोहारि च दुर्लभं वचः (Hitam Manohari cha Durlabham Vachah) — Paper 5

Paper 5 — (progressively harder)

Marking: +4 correct, -1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	A	11	A	21	D	31	B	41	A	51	D
2	A	12	A	22	A	32	B	42	C	52	D
3	B	13	D	23	A	33	B	43	D	53	B
4	C	14	C	24	D	34	A	44	C	54	B
5	A	15	C	25	A	35	D	45	C	55	C
6	D	16	D	26	D	36	B	46	A	56	D
7	A	17	B	27	D	37	A	47	C	57	B
8	C	18	B	28	C	38	C	48	B	58	A
9	B	19	D	29	D	39	C	49	C	59	B
10	A	20	C	30	C	40	D	50	B	60	B

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

1. (A) The minimum overlap of two sets in a fixed total is (size A + size B – total) when that is positive: twenty plus twenty-four minus forty leaves four guaranteed to be both. Assuming all useful are pleasing fixes overlap at one set's size rather than its minimum; claiming zero overlap mistakes 'rare' for 'impossible' and ignores that the counts force at least some shared members.

2. (A) Usefulness and pleasantness pick out genuinely different qualities; the whole point is that their co-occurrence is rare, so erasing one widens the field from a narrow overlap to a broad single class. Treating them as synonyms denies that very rarity; singling out दुर्लभम् misreads which words carry the contrast; and the objection is semantic, not a bare grammar rule.

3. (B) The doctor's words both help (true, actionable) and please (gentle, hopeful), meeting both halves at once. The cheerful false promise pleases but does not benefit; the

contemptuous correct insult benefits but does not please; the silent friend supplies neither benefit nor pleasantness.

4. (C) Each extra independent condition intersects the field again, leaving a smaller subset, so more demands mean greater rarity. The 'more ways to qualify' picture confuses conjunction with disjunction; rarity is not a fixed floor; and a harder-yet-reachable goal is still दुर्लभम्, not the categorically impossible अशक्यम्.

5. (A) The critic owns the हितम् half and the flatterer the मनोहारि half; fusing the truthful benefit with the agreeable manner yields the rare both-AND speech. Keeping only pleasantness or only usefulness reproduces a one-half failure, and there is no reason the fusion of two strengths would yield the two corresponding weaknesses.

6. (D) Either quality alone is reasonably attainable; what is hard is having both at once, so attaching rarity to the conjunction names the exact difficulty. Useful speech is not by itself near-impossible; pleasing speech is not condemned (it is half the ideal); and no grammatical rule bars separate praise — the choice is rhetorical and pointed.

7. (A) दुर्लभम् asserts that something is hard to obtain — still obtainable — whereas अशक्यम् denies obtainability altogether; that is a difference in kind, not a matter of how close two points sit. So 'practically impossible' smuggles अशक्यम् back in; the word is neither a midpoint nor identical to the impossible extreme.

8. (C) Because the only changed element is the prefix, the opposite meanings must come from the prefixes, fixing दुर्- as 'hard/ill' and सु- as 'easy/well'. So the prefixes are not empty, their senses are not reversed, and they do not push the meaning the same way.

9. (B) Exhorting effort presupposes the goal can be reached; अशक्यम् denies that, gutting the exhortation, whereas दुर्लभम् keeps it attainable-though-rare. अशक्यम् does not mean 'common', is not a synonym of दुर्लभम्, and an unreachable goal cannot coherently justify striving.

10. (A) The both-AND ideal is hard but achievable, hence दुर्लभम्, while a truly unutterable speech would be अशक्यम्. The two words are not synonyms, the labels do not swap (impossible is harder than rare), and combining two qualities narrows rather than widens the field, so (ii) is certainly not easy.

11. (A) Across दुर्लभ, दुर्गम and दुर्बोध the prefix दुर्- consistently means 'hard to', attaching difficulty to the base act, so दुर्बोधम् is 'hard to understand'. It does not flatly negate (that would be the अशक्यम् sense), does not commend like सु-, and does not double the action.

12. (A) दुर्लभम् from दुर्+लभ् concerns difficulty of obtaining, i.e. scarcity of occurrence; the speech's worth is supplied by the separate adjectives हितम् and मनोहारि. So 'rarely valuable' confuses scarcity with worth; it does not mean 'always valuable'; and as a neuter-singular adjective it qualifies वचः, not the manner of speaking.

13. (D) A Sanskrit adjective inherits its noun's gender, number and case; वचः being neuter singular forces neuter-singular qualifiers. Adjectives do not default to masculine, their own count does not pluralise them, and unlike adverbs they do decline to agree.

14. (C) Agreement tracks the noun's gender: a masculine head noun pulls the adjective into masculine हितः. The neuter हितम् would now mismatch, the feminine हिता has no warrant, and a single head noun does not trigger a plural adjective.

15. (C) वचः derives from the stem वचस्, whose final -स् appears as visarga at word end, paralleling मनस्→मनः. It is not the prefix -रु, not a nasal -न्, and not a dental -त्; the -स् stem class is what unites वचः with मनः and तेजः.

16. (D) Shared neuter-singular agreement marks हितम्, मनोहारि and दुर्लभम् as qualifiers of the one noun वचः, not co-equal nouns. They are not verbs, they share rather than differ in case, and वचः ('speech') is plainly the substantive being described.

17. (B) The conjunction च survives, but दुर्लभम् has flipped to its opposite सुलभम् (a real, claim-weakening change), while मधुरम् merely re-words the pleasing quality (मनोहारि). It does not touch च→वा, सुलभ and दुर्लभ are opposites not synonyms, and replacing 'rare' with 'easy' loosens rather than tightens the standard.

18. (B) मनः in मनोहारि is the very -स् stem of वचः/मनस्, whose visarga becomes 'o' before the voiced ह. The -वान् of क्रियावान् is a possessive suffix, दुर्- is a prefix, and the -शः of क्षणशः is the distributive -शस् suffix — none are neuter -स् noun stems.

19. (D) The seam is a visarga (after an 'a') meeting the voiced ह, which converts the visarga to the vowel 'o', yielding मनो-. There is no vowel-meets-vowel junction (so the like-vowel rule does not apply), no consonant doubling occurs, and the shift is a rule, not a spelling whim.

20. (C) The visarga-to-'o' shift in मनोहारि depends specifically on the FOLLOWING sound being voiced (ह); before a voiceless क् the visarga does not become 'o'. So 'o' is not automatic before every consonant, the preceding vowel does not lengthen, and the visarga does not merely vanish.

21. (D) Two similar simple vowels (उ + उ) merge into the corresponding long vowel ऊ, so सु+उक्ति becomes सूक्ति; the semivowel व् would only arise if उ met an UNLIKE vowel. The 'a + i → e' rule is irrelevant (no such vowels here), the result is a long vowel not a diphthong औ, and the vowels do merge rather than stand apart.

22. (A) Vowel sandhi requires a vowel ending meeting a vowel beginning; since च opens with the consonant च्, the trigger is simply absent and the enclitic stands written separately. मनोहारि does end in a vowel, च is a particle not a verb, and the explanation owes nothing to emphasis.

23. (A) A postposed enclitic च ties the word it follows back to the preceding item, so it joins मनोहारि to हितम्, yielding the both-AND pairing. It does not reach forward to वचः/दुर्लभम्, does not attach only to a following word, and does not link all four indiscriminately.

24. (D) सूक्तिः coalesced because सु's उ met उक्ति's उ (vowel + vowel); in सुभाषितम् the सु meets the consonant भ्, so no vowel merger occurs and सु stays short. There is no long ऊ here, सु means 'well/good', and भाषितम् begins with a consonant, not a vowel.

25. (A) The suffix -शस् builds a fixed, indeclinable distributive adverb that never inflects for case, so no instrumental form exists at all. Both कणशसा and कणश्या wrongly assume it declines; and it is an adverb, not a verb to be conjugated.

26. (D) Study is measured in moments of time and saving in physical particles, so क्षणशः suits विद्या and कणशः suits अर्थः by the very nature of how each grows. Knowledge is not literally made of time-units, the match is principled rather than arbitrary, and the two adverbs carry distinct senses.

27. (D) कर्म + -शस् mirrors क्षण/कण + -शस्, producing an indeclinable 'deed by deed' adverb. It is not a finite verb, not a dative noun, and not an agreeing adjective — the -शस् form never declines to match anything.

28. (C) Learning by daily study sessions is accumulation over units of time, matching क्षणशः; कणशः is reserved for grain/coin-style physical saving. The growth was gradual (so an adverb does apply), and the two adverbs are not freely interchangeable — each fits a distinct mode of accumulation.

29. (D) Both share the identical distributive suffix -शस्; the meaning split rides entirely on the bases क्षण (time) versus कण (particle). The suffixes are the same, indeclinable adverbs carry no gender, and the two are genuinely distinct words, not variants.

30. (C) The common suffix signals a common pattern — incremental accumulation — even though the units differ (moments vs particles). Knowledge and wealth are not identical, -शस् is not the sole adverb-former, and the indeclinable suffix imposes no gender.

31. (B) The suffix -वान् means 'possessing', and क्रिया from कृ is genuine doing, so क्रियावान् is the possessor of action, a doer. -वान् is not privative, the word concerns doing rather than describing, and it carries no sense of opposing action.

32. (B) The doer is the one whose finished work needs no announcement (A); the boaster is the one whose words run ahead of unfinished deeds (B). Loud forecasting is talk, not doing; producing real work does not make one a boaster; and merely speaking aloud is not the mark of a doer.

33. (B) Both teachings put substance above show: real deeds over boasting, and genuinely beneficial-pleasing speech over hollow words — so they reinforce, not contradict, each

other. The chapter does not prize talk over deeds, the contrast is not about wealth versus knowledge, and it counsels worthy speech and action, not silence.

34. (A) Just as pleasing words without real benefit fail the speech ideal, eloquent promises without real deeds fail the doer ideal — both substitute show for substance. The adverb-swap, the saying-vs-subtle confusion, and the rare-vs-easy slip are different traps that do not capture this show-over-substance parallel.

35. (D) The chapter prizes the doer whose action makes boasting superfluous, which the first proverb captures. Promising before doing, ranking boasts above deeds, and counselling inertia all invert or abandon the कर्म-over-कथन lesson.

36. (B) Only सूक्तिः contains the element उक्ति ('saying'), anchoring it to speech, while सूक्ष्म lacks it and means 'subtle/fine'. So they are not both speech-words, सूक्ष्म is not a kind of saying, and a shared opening syllable does not create synonymy.

37. (A) 'Subtle riddle' is the meaning of सूक्ष्म, the lookalike, whereas a सूक्तिः (सु+उक्ति) is a well-spoken maxim akin to सुभाषितम्. It is not a boast (विकृत्यन), not a treasure-list (भाण्डागारः), and not a roster of curiosities (कुतूहलम्).

38. (C) कुतूहल, कौतुक and जिज्ञासा all name the desire to learn, which the chapter treats as the engine of knowledge gathered moment by moment. They concern neither boasting, nor rest, nor greed for wealth.

39. (C) As a desiderative of ज्ञा, जिज्ञासा is the desire to know, and that curiosity powers the patient क्षणशः study that builds विद्या. It is not a wish for wealth, not a wish to boast (which the chapter criticises), and not a wish to rest.

40. (D) Both a storehouse and क्षणशः-knowledge grow by gradual, repeated additions, so the image fits incremental learning. A storehouse does not fill instantly, the metaphor is meant earnestly (not ironic about coins), and it is an image of fullness, not emptiness.

41. (A) Fine speech and riches are outward gifts; the cheat's dishonesty exposes the inner lack the chapter prizes most — शीलम्. He already has speech and wealth, and curiosity is simply not the value at issue.

42. (C) The recurrence of शीलम् alongside genuine speech and deeds marks the prized figure as inwardly good, with outward acts expressing that character. The ideal is not mere outward impressiveness, not riches alone, and not eloquence alone.

43. (D) Only the respectful-yet-honest delivery meets both halves at once. Vague praise drops the हितम् (no real help), the humiliating rebuke drops the मनोहारि (no pleasantness), and silence drops both — each failing a different, specific half of the ideal.

44. (C) The verse makes the both-AND quality SUFFICIENT for rarity, not the reverse; affirming the consequent (rare therefore both) is a fallacy, since speech may be rare for many other reasons. So rarity alone tells us neither 'it is both', nor 'it is neither', nor that it is common.

45. (C) A wounding rebuke can help (हितम्) yet still sting (not मनोहारि), so it satisfies only the usefulness half; truth is not inherently pleasing. It is not pleasing-but-useless, and it is not wholly outside the verse since it does carry benefit.

46. (A) A misleading slogan pleases but does not genuinely benefit, so it lacks हितम्, and the both-AND ideal requires both qualities. मनोहारि is not condemned (it is half the ideal), pleasantness alone is insufficient, and the failure is substantive, not grammatical.

47. (C) Requiring both narrows the field to the overlap of the two sets, which is no larger than either alone, so such candidates are rarer — the abstract form of दुर्लभम्. Two conjoined criteria do not multiply the ways to qualify, the count does change, and 'rare' is not 'impossible'.

48. (B) Both clusters elevate the harder, genuine good — speech that truly helps and pleases, and learning/wealth/deeds patiently earned — over the cheap or hollow alternative. They do not exalt boasting or effortless instant results, and they are unified rather than opposed.

49. (C) Ideal speech is दुर्लभम् (rare-but-reachable) and knowledge/wealth grow bit by bit, so both verses point to patient, incremental effort toward hard-but-attainable goods. They are not easy/instant, not impossible, and not won by boasting.

50. (B) The chapter weaves both-AND speech, patient क्षणशः/कणशः accumulation, deeds over boasting, and शीलम् as the crowning value — exactly the first rule. The others invert the speech ideal, abandon effort, or drop usefulness and character.

51. (D) Only the first set is right throughout: rare, pleasing, doer, good saying. The other sets each smuggle in classic errors — 'impossible' for दुर्लभम्, 'useful' or 'harsh' for मनोहारि (which means pleasing), 'boaster' for क्रियावान्, or 'subtle' for सूक्तिः.

52. (D) च is 'and' not 'or'; दुर्लभम् is 'rare' not impossible; मनोहारि is 'heart-stealing/pleasing' not mind-harming; and क्षणशः is the distributive 'moment by moment', not 'all at once' — every one of the four is mistaken.

53. (B) Mirroring हितं मनोहारि च, the added words would be neuter-singular adjectives conjoined by च ('and') and agreeing with वचः. They are not 'or'-linked nouns, not adverbs on दुर्लभम्, and not a subject-object-verb triple.

54. (B) Naming the both-AND speech a rare yet reachable ideal frames it as something worth striving for — an ethical nudge, not bare parsing. A description of an ideal does

carry value, the line is not a grammar exercise, and दुर्लभम् concerns the rarity of such speech, not market goods.

55. (C) सूक्तिः (wise saying), कुतूहलम् (curiosity), भाण्डागारः (treasured store of knowledge) and शीलम् (character) map onto wise speech, curiosity, valued learning and good character. The other lists invert the chapter's values.

56. (D) The chapter condemns hollow boasting, not worthy speech; beneficial-and-pleasing words are themselves a genuine contribution that sits alongside real deeds. So neither cluster is abandoned, and speaking and doing remain distinct activities the chapter values for the same reason — substance over show.

57. (B) Curiosity speaks to gain knowledge; boasting speaks to praise oneself — so eager questioning is कुतूहलम्, not विकल्थन. Frequent speaking is not automatically boasting, curiosity is expressed through asking rather than silence, and she is a curious learner, not literally a 'storehouse'.

58. (A) दुर्लभम् keeps ideal speech attainable, matching the message that knowledge and wealth accrue gradually through patient effort — both reward perseverance. They do not teach impossibility, do not promise instant gain, and they pull in the same direction.

59. (B) वचः ('speech') is the substantive, and the three adjectives describe it by sharing its neuter-singular form. दुर्लभम् and हितम् are qualifiers, not the head noun, and the line is not four parallel nouns.

60. (B) The faithful restatement keeps the conjunction (both), the correct sense of दुर्लभम् (rare-but-attainable), and the implied encouragement to strive. The distractors variously swap 'and' for 'or' and 'rare' for 'easy', declare impossibility, or wrongly condemn pleasing speech.